
SESSION 2D

CONFESSION AND REPENTANCE LOOP



The demons lose their power when we confess that we have been in their clutches. ¹

– Henri Nouwen, *The Only Necessary Thing*



Without the cross the Disciplines of confession would be only psychologically therapeutic. But it is so much more. It involves an objective change in our relationship with God and a subjective change in us. It is a means of healing and transforming the inner spirit. ²

– Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*

A generalized confession may save us from humiliation and shame, but it will not ignite inner healing. The people who came to Jesus came with obvious, specific sins, and they were forgiven for each one. It is far too easy to avoid our real guilt in a general confession. In our confession we bring concrete sins. By calling them concrete, however, I do not mean only outward sins. I mean definite sins, the sins of the heart-pride, avarice, anger, fear—as well as the sins of the flesh—sloth, gluttony, adultery, murder. ³

–Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*

One further note on the preparation for confession; there must be a definite termination point in the self-examination process. Otherwise, we can easily fall into a permanent habit of self-condemnation. Confession begins in sorrow but it ends in joy. There is celebration in the forgiveness of sins because it results in a genuinely changed life. ⁴

- Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*

"Here's the thing: an emotional catharsis may feel redemptive. It feels too good to tell a friend, or a pastor, or a priest, where you messed up and have him tell you it's all going to be OK, that you are still a good person. Their affirmation, however, cannot reestablish your relationship to God. Only Jesus can do that. Our tears do not wash away our sin. Only Jesus' blood does. ⁵

- J.D. Greear, *Stop Asking Jesus Into Your Heart*

¹ Henri Nouwen, *The Only Necessary Thing: Living a Prayerful Life*. New York, New York: The Crossroad Publishing Company. 2008. p.158.

² Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*. New York, New York: HarperSanFrancisco. 1998. p. 144.

³ Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*. New York, New York: HarperSanFrancisco. 1998. p.152.

⁴ Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline*. New York, New York: HarperSanFrancisco. 1998. p. 153.

⁵ J.D. Greear, *Stop Asking Jesus Into Your Heart*. 2013. Nashville, Tennessee: B&H Publishing Group. p. 58.

APPLY IT!

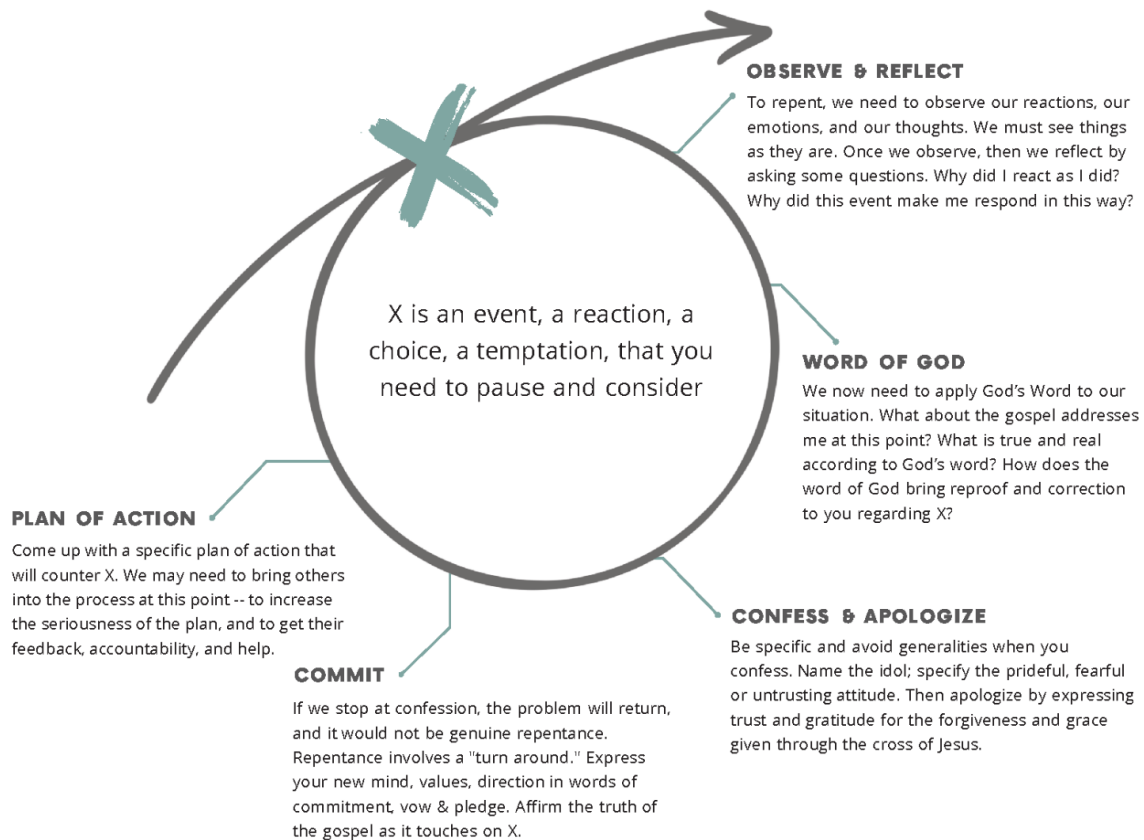
Read through the Repentance Loop document attached below.

Then think over the past week, and choose an incident through which the Holy Spirit is convicting you of some sin and write a response as you move through the steps of the repentance loop.

FIGHTING FOR YOUR SOUL

2 Timothy 3:16-17

"All Scripture is breathed out by God and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for training in righteousness, that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work."



For the Word of God to turn sinners into a "man (woman) of God ... complete, equipped for every good work", there needs to be a process of "training in righteousness." This process involves you bringing your life before God's Word for teaching, reproof, and correction. It takes effort for the Word to confront our sinful lives, but if we persevere and repent based on God's Word, we become trained in righteousness.